



Indiana University — Department of Economics
Fundamentals of Economics for Business II (ECON-B252)
Spring 2024, Section 12380, TR 9:45 - 11:00AM, Woodburn Hall (WH) 111

1 Course Info

Instructor: Anthony Vecchia

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Office: Wylie Hall (WY) 244 (shared office)

Office Hours: M 1:30 - 2:30PM & TR 12:00 - 1:00PM, or by appointment. Office hours are walk-in. Just stop in!

Assistant:

Course Objectives: This course is a continuation of ECON-B251. It primarily covers macroeconomics. By the end of the semester students should be able to...

1. Identify, describe, and relate the main macroeconomic variables to their respective macroeconomic objectives. Be able to measure these variables with real data.
2. Use models to describe, illustrate, and apply the main variables to macroeconomic objectives and assess change in both the long run and the short run.
3. Explain how basic fiscal policy functions and affects the main variables to solve the two basic macroeconomic problems. Describe the different types of federal budgets.
4. Explain how money, banks, interest rates, and monetary policy function and relate to each other. Describe how Federal Reserve policies, goals, and targets affect the main variables and solve the two basic macroeconomic problems.
5. Define and measure the main categories of international trade. Explain how basic exchange rate markets function and determine equilibrium. Describe how policies affect international trade and exchange rates.

Prerequisite(s): ECON-B251 or equivalent.

Credit Hours: 3

Materials: Required: *Introductory Macroeconomics* by Paul Graf (IU eText, register via Top Hat through the course Canvas site) and a calculator.

2 Exams, Homework & Grades

Exams: There will be three exams: **Exam 1 (R Feb 15)**, **Exam 2 (R Mar 28)**, and the **Final Exam (F May 3 8:00 - 10:00AM)**. The Final Exam may take place in a different classroom. The Final Exam will be cumulative. Exams will primarily be multiple choice bubble sheets, but may contain a supplemental, hand-written portion. Students are permitted to have a basic calculator. Make-up exams will NOT be granted unless I receive notification of a valid excuse *prior* to the exam (see course policies below). The Final Exam time cannot be changed. *Any student with conflicting final exams should change sections ASAP.* Click here for IU Final Exam policy.

Homework: There will be almost-weekly, open-note homework due Mondays at 11:59pm covering the previous week's lecture AND textbook material. Homework will be administered via online Canvas quizzes (eight 15 pt. and three 10 pt. homeworks). Students will be given two attempts of somewhat different questions. The highest score will be kept. Late work is accepted, but penalized at 1% per hour.

Discussions: Four times throughout the semester (25 pts. each) we will have brief discussions on current events and/or data. I will present the material and students will be broken into small groups. Students will submit independent notes on what they learned and how it relates to course material on Canvas within two days. I will announce the discussions at least a week in advance. Any students who miss class may make up the assignment on Canvas.

Attendance: Attendance counts towards your final grade and will be measured using embedded in-class questions via Top Hat. Please register for Top Hat via the link on our course Canvas site *by the end of the first week of class (attendance will start in the second week)*. I will take attendance for twenty-three lectures (not review/exam dates) at 3 pts. each. Any points beyond 50 will be counted as bonus. This implies students may miss six lectures *unconditionally*. I hope to provide meaningful material and tips during lecture that are worth your time. Furthermore, my lectures will complement the textbook, NOT replace it.

Grading: The course is worth 1000 points. Students are expected to regularly check their grades in Canvas. However, please note that **the Canvas gradebook may not always be accurate**. It is a work-in-progress (particularly the attendance grade). If you have any grading issues or concerns, it is always best to reach out to me. There will not be any extra credit given beyond what has already been specified in the Attendance subsection. I reserve the right to *lower* the thresholds for any letter grade.

Exam 1	225 pts.	A+ ≥ 975 pts.	C+ ≥ 755 pts.
Exam 2	225	A ≥ 915	C ≥ 715
Final Exam	250	A- ≥ 885	C- ≥ 685
Homework	150	B+ ≥ 855	D+ ≥ 655
Discussions	100	B ≥ 815	D ≥ 595
Attendance*	50	B- ≥ 785	D- ≥ 555
Total	1000		F < 555

* 19 points of extra credit are possible here

3 Course Organization, Policies & Useful Info

Course Organization: There will be in-person lectures and out-of-class learning. Students are expected to read the material prior to attending lecture and complete homework after lecture. All class material and grades can be accessed through our course Canvas site (including Top Hat). Any Canvas announcements will be official class communications (e.g. delayed due date, exam info, etc.). Students can contact me via email and expect a response within 48 weekday hours.

Expectations: *My expectations of you:* I expect you to be determined and responsible. Work hard to understand material you find challenging and ask for help when you need it. Be organized and knowledgeable of material *and* deadlines. Be professional to your classmates and I. Be respectful during class and honest with your work. *Your expectations of me:* My job is to teach you how to think like an economist. I will come prepared to lecture and work hard to make material understandable. Furthermore, I will always answer your questions whenever I can. I will be fair to all students in grading. Lastly, I will preserve a peaceful learning environment. I will always

respond to disruptions or interference.

Valid Excuses: Extensions, make-up exams, excused absence, and more will ONLY be granted for valid excuses. These include illness or injury lasting more than five days (note from healthcare provider stating “unable to attend”), family emergencies (email me ASAP), certain university approved activities (university documentation at least one week prior), or certain religious holidays (notification in the first three weeks of class). Recall that I allow five *unconditionally* excused absences. If you have run out of excused absences, I require documentation as soon as possible. When in doubt, email me!

Academic Integrity: We will not tolerate any dishonesty in this course. Dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, cheating, plagiarizing, fabricating information or citations, *facilitating* acts of academic dishonesty by others, having unauthorized possession of exams, submitting work of another person (or an AI program) or work previously used without informing the instructor, or tampering with academic work of other students. Students who are found dishonest will receive the most severe academic sanction consistent with IU policies. A minimum penalty for any breach of academic integrity is a 0 for the assignment, but it may result in an “F” for the course. Ignorance is not an excuse. **Note-Selling:** Selling the instructor’s materials or uploading course assignments to websites (even after the course has ended) is strictly forbidden. Violation of this policy will be reported to the Dean of Students (Office of Student Conduct) as academic misconduct. Additionally, selling an instructor’s notes/study guides using an IU email or via Canvas may also constitute a violation of IU information technology and intellectual property policies; additional consequences may apply. **AI:** Your use of any AI system’s (e.g. ChatGPT, Bard, and Dall-E) words, calculations, or ideas for homework or exams is forbidden. AI programs should not be used for any classwork without explicit permission of the instructor and appropriate attribution. **Messaging Platforms:** While platforms like GroupMe, Discord, and others can be an effective way of collaborative learning, they can also be sources of unauthorized information sharing or cheating. Sharing or discussing answers on these platforms without instructor permission is considered cheating. If academic dishonesty occurs via messaging platforms, everyone involved in the thread may be found responsible for academic misconduct.

Accessible Educational Services: Every attempt will be made to accommodate qualified students (e.g. mental health, learning, chronic health, physical hearing, vision neurological, etc.). Note that services are confidential, may take time, and are not retroactive; captions and alternate media for print materials may take three or more weeks to accommodate. You must have established your eligibility for support services through the campus office as soon as possible. Preferably, I will receive notification of your accommodations (if applicable) in the first week of class.

Withdrawal: The last day for an automatic “W” is Sunday, March 10th, 2024. It is also the last day to get a withdrawal slip signed without a special petition. This and all other important deadlines can be found here. The instructor is not responsible for dropping enrolled students.

Support: Use the following resources for help. **Tech:** knowledge base or 24/7 UITS help desk.

Academic: SAC or tutoring services. **Protect IU:** IU emergency protocol. Call 9-1-1 for emergencies and (812)-855-4111 for non-emergencies. **Counseling:** Contact counseling and psychological services if you need someone who will listen!

Unforeseen Circumstances: I may need to modify course administration and policies in order to follow university, local, state, or federal mandates. I will always communicate these modifications through Canvas announcements.

Sexual Misconduct & Title IX: IU policy prohibits sexual misconduct in any form, including sexual harassment, sexual assault, stalking, sexual exploitation, and domestic violence. If you have experienced sexual misconduct or know someone who has, you may speak to someone confidentially. Call the IU Sexual Assault Crisis Services at (812)-855-5711 or contact a Confidential Victim Advo-

cate at (812)-856-2469 or cva@indiana.edu. It is also vital you know university policy requires me to share certain information brought to my attention about potential sexual misconduct with the campus Deputy Sexual Misconduct & Title IX Coordinator. In that event, those individuals will work to ensure that appropriate measures are taken, and resources are made available. Protecting student privacy is of utmost concern, and information will only be shared with those that need to know to ensure the University can respond and assist. [Learn more here.](#)

4 Tentative Schedule

Date	Content	To-Do
T Jan 9	Class Introduction	Register for Top Hat by end of week
R Jan 11	M1 - Unemployment	HW1 due M Jan 15 at 11:59PM
T Jan 16	M2 - Inflation	Attendance begins
R Jan 18	M2 - Inflation	HW2 due M Jan 22 at 11:59PM
T Jan 23	M3 - GDP	
R Jan 25	M3 - GDP	HW3 due M Jan 29 at 11:59PM
T Jan 30	M4 - Long Run Growth	
R Feb 1	M4 - Long Run Growth	HW4 due M Feb 5 at 11:59PM
T Feb 6	M5 - LRAS & AD	
R Feb 8	M5 - LRAS & AD	HW5 due M Feb 12 at 11:59PM
T Feb 13	Review for Exam 1	
R Feb 15	Exam 1	Exam 1 from 9:45 - 11:00AM (M1 - M5)
T Feb 20	M6 - SRAS & AD	
R Feb 22	M6 - SRAS & AD	HW6 due M Feb 26 at 11:59PM
T Feb 27	M7 - Aggregate Expenditures	
R Feb 29	M7 - Aggregate Expenditures	HW7 due M Mar 4 at 11:59PM
T Mar 5	M8 - Loanable Funds	
R Mar 7	M8 - Loanable Funds	HW8 due M Mar 18 at 11:59PM
T Mar 12	NO CLASS (Spring Break)	
R Mar 14	NO CLASS (Spring Break)	
T Mar 19	M9 - Fiscal Policy	
R Mar 21	M9 - Fiscal Policy	HW9 due M Mar 25 at 11:59PM
T Mar 26	Review for Exam 2	
R Mar 28	Exam 2	Exam 2 from 9:45 - 11:00AM (M6 - M9)
T Apr 2	M10/11 - Banking/Monetary Policy	
R Apr 4	M10/11 - Banking/Monetary Policy	
T Apr 9	M10/11 - Banking/Monetary Policy	HW10 due M Apr 15 at 11:59PM
R Apr 11	M12 - International Markets	
T Apr 16	M12 - International Markets	HW11 due M Apr 22 at 11:59PM
R Apr 18	M13 - Labor Markets	
T Apr 23	M13 - Labor Markets	
R Apr 25	Review Monopolistic Competition	
F May 3	Final Exam	Final Exam from 8:00 - 10:00AM (cumulative)